

10 inch retina tablet display

Samsung has announced a 10-inch retina (300 dpi or higher) display for tablets based on their PenTile technology

iPad 3 display rumours

Samsung is reportedly developing a 2048x1536 pixel display. Could this be Retina for the iPad 3?

40/42-inch TVs: where the real fun begins

If you're an HDTV owner, or are waiting to hop aboard the bandwagon, you might be wanting to watch a lot of HD content on your TV, or even convert a part of your home into a little cinema theatre. For such purposes the bigger the better, and there's nothing like a screen that fills your vision with its image. However, you're also one who doesn't want to part with a lot of liquidity. The 40/42-inch size class of TVs has seen a lot of price drops happening, as well as the influx of new models.

Build, ergonomics and features

The Sharp Aquos LE820 was a real beast – heavy, and well built, in fact the heaviest of the LED displays in this lot. The LG 42LV3730 was the lightest of the displays, and had a nice glossy black finish. Of all these displays, only LG uses a metal rear, the other three were plastic. The Onida LEO40HMS was the heaviest of the bunch, mainly owing to the massively thick plastic panel on its rear. The LG LFLV3730 had the slimmest bezel among these TVs. The Hitachi LE42T05A is well built, although the stand doesn't swivel well and the bezel is a bit too wide. We also found the bright blue power light a little obtrusive. The menu is sparse, some options were there, but they were greyed out. Incidentally, this was the only TV with USB that didn't read our thumb drive, nor our external HDD with .DivX files.

The LG LFLV3730 had the deepest menu system, very detailed with a wealth of settings. Incidentally, this LG

TV has a semi-gloss display, that while not matte like some of the other panels, wasn't glossy like the larger Samsung UA46D6600WR. The Sharp Aquos LE820 also had detailed settings, but we feel the naming convention needs to be simplified for home users, as it is, it seems designed for engineers with the terms used.

Performance

At the very outset, the Sharp Aquos LE820 blew the competition out of the water. Well, not price wise any ways, for it was also close to double the price of the other TVs in this group, but in terms of sheer performance. While the difference isn't night and day, it is definitely visible, and those purists who seek that extra bit of colour depth, and that extra blackness level and contrast will surely find it. The Aquos LE820 performed marvelously in our movie tests – in *Avatar* the foliage literally comes to life and the specular effects of dappled sunlight are very realistic. There is also a lot of sharpness in the image, without any sort of graininess. It also handles 720p content well, and in *Ironman 2* the electricity effects on Whiplash's suit, and the explosions are really cinematic. Sharp uses a different panel, with 4 colour elements i.e. RGYB colour gamut instead of RGB as there is a yellow component as well.

The LG 42LV3730 doesn't even come close to the Sharp Aquos LE820, but it does handle the tests fairly well despite a fairly mediocre static contrast ratio of 346:1. We felt this TV "masks" its shortcomings really well, and while colours lack that extra bit of reality and appear a little muted sometimes, the greenery and animal skins in *Avatar* look very nice, and there's a fair bit of punch to the brighter scenes with weapon effects and such looking pretty good. In shadowy regions, and darker scenes, the LG loses out and banding is plainly visible.

The Hitachi LE42T05A suffers from mediocre colour and contrast, and everything looks a little muted and lacking in detail as a result. It is about at par with the Onida LEO40HMS.

Winners

It wasn't one of the larger TVs than won the best per-

For its razor-sharp image, colours and a whopping contrast of 1096:1 as per the Spyder, it wins our Best Performance award. LGs 42LV3730 bagged our Best Buy award, and if you're shopping for a good 42-inch TV, for ₹68,490, this one makes a pretty good deal.



LG 42LV3730

46-inch TVs: Home cinema starts here

This is an interesting category because TVs of this size were priced above ₹1,00,000 last year, but owing to demand and a shift in preference of consumers towards larger displays, prices have fallen. Other than the Vu LC-46V86P, the other three models here are LED-backlit LCDs.

Build, ergonomics and features

Samsung's UA46D6600WR was definitely one of the sleekest displays we've seen with a bezel that is slim enough to give LCD monitors a major inferiority complex. It's also a very light display, one of the lightest in this comparison. The Hitachi LE46T05A was rather nondescript looking, but the stand despite looking identical to the smaller Hitachi display and was more stable and permitted easier swivel.



Sharp Aquos LE820

formance award. Rather it was the Sharp Aquos LE820 that impressed beyond even the larger 46 inch - 55 inch displays.